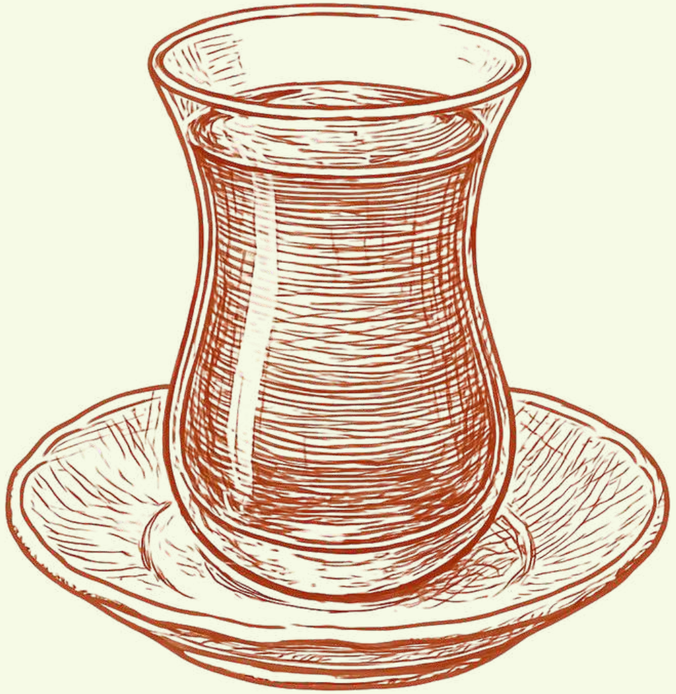
DESIGN MILESTONES

Işıl Nehir Aslan
IDE202

KEYWORDS

- Turkish tea culture
- Hotel room experience
- Cultural introduction for tourists
- Electric samovar
- Compact tea machine
- Hospitality design
- Ritual of tea drinking
- Minimal traditional aesthetics



Selected Impactful prompts

Prompt 1:
"How can Turkish tea culture be introduced to tourists in hotel rooms through a small appliance?"
Prompt 2:
"What are the traditional features of a Turkish samovar and how can they be simplified for modern electric use?"
Prompt 3:
"How can the tea brewing process be simplified for tourists who do not know Turkish tea preparation?"

AI ROLE TAGS

Clarifier: AI clarified the history and functioning of Turkish tea and samovars.

Expander: AI suggested new ideas such as capsule tea and cultural interaction elements.

Re-framer: AI helped shift the focus from a traditional samovar to a hotel user experience.

Critique: AI highlighted the limitations of traditional samovars such as size and complexity.

AI Response Summaries

AI helped me to understand the history of Turkish tea and samovars and their cultural importance.
It also explained advantages and disadvantages of traditional samovars, such as size, complexity, and heating methods.
It also helped explore how tourists experience tea culture and how design can create a small cultural ritual in hotel rooms.

Reflections

Using AI helped me explore different directions quickly.
It helped me understand both cultural aspects and technical aspects of tea brewing.
However, not all suggestions were directly useful for my project. I needed to adapt the information to a hotel context, focusing on simplicity and compact size.
AI worked mainly as a research assistant and idea generator, while the final design decisions were made by me.

Design Decisions

Based on research and AI suggestions, I decided to:

- Design a compact electric samovar-inspired tea machine
- Create a system suitable for hotel room use
- Provide two traditional Turkish tea glasses
- Add a QR code explaining Turkish tea culture
- Keep the form minimal but inspired by traditional samovar shapes

What I Accepted, Rejected, and Transformed

Accepted
- Electric heating system
- Capsule tea portions
- Compact design for hotel rooms

Rejected
- Large traditional samovar structure
- Complex brewing steps
- Multiple separate components

Transformed
- Traditional samovar form → simplified modern shape
- Traditional tea ritual → easy 3-step brewing process
- Cultural storytelling → QR code interaction

Visual Timeline

01

I started with a quick sketch to explore the traditional samovar form and understand the basic proportions and structure.

02

I created the first digital concept to visualize the classic samovar form with traditional decorative details.

03

The upper teapot was simplified to make the overall form cleaner and more balanced.

04

Traditional patterns were added to emphasize the cultural identity of Turkish tea.

05

The material was changed to copper to reflect the warm and traditional aesthetic of historical samovars.

06

The proportions were refined to create a more elegant and cohesive traditional silhouette.

07

The design was adapted for hotel rooms, allowing tourists to experience and learn about the Turkish tea ritual in a compact format.